COMPARISON · MATRIX · STRUCTURE

matrix-2x2

Static 2×2 quadrant grid with author-placed items per cell.

The matrix places items on two named axes.

High impact · Low effort.

Quick wins

Two per cell

High impact · High effort.

Strategic bets

Named plainly

Low impact · Low effort.

Habit fillers

Prune here

Low impact · High effort.

Time sinks

One suffices

Three items per cell is the matrix ceiling.

High impact · Low effort.

Three short items
Fit each cell
At the ceiling

High impact · High effort.

Labels stay short
Sixteen words hard
Per cell entry

Low impact · Low effort.

Past three items
The quadrants crowd
Split the story

Low impact · High effort.

A fourth entry
Does not fit
Stop at three

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When NOT to reach for matrix-2x2.

Continuous-axis data

If items have x/y coordinates rather than quadrant labels, use `quadrant`. matrix-2x2 is author-placed categorical, not plotted.

Empty quadrants left blank

An empty cell still needs a label or an explicit (none) placeholder. A missing card breaks the 2×2 symmetry.

More than 4 items per cell

Each quadrant holds 1–4 items. Past that the cells crowd. Promote inner items to their own slide if needed.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`quadrant` — items have continuous x/y coordinates rather than discrete quadrant labels

`verdict-grid` — options scored across more than two dimensions

`obligation-matrix` — many rows × many columns of state-marker cells

`matrix-grid` — both axes are ordered categories and cells mark one position, not four free quadrants

`cards-grid` — the items don't divide along two axes